

My Code of Ethics for Design

デザイン設計倫理



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My Voice 声明



I want to make things that are **honest**.
And always make sure to be **transparent**
in my process of craft.

I am a designer who grew up between two cultures, understanding the intersection of different values. I have a creative family back in my home country, and I carry with me a deep appreciation for the care and intention behind every artifact they made.

Two orange paper airplanes are shown in flight against a background of soft, white clouds. The airplane on the left is larger and further along its path, while the one on the right is smaller and just beginning its ascent.

Now living in Vancouver, where emerging technology, including AI, is all around, I have figured out this: good design is not just about how something looks with high-end software. It is about who it serves, who made it, and whether it is honest and true about who you are.

Principles 原則

-  **Don't design to deceive.** If a client asks me to make something look eco-friendly when it isn't, or to hide a "cancel" button, I won't do it. Dark patterns are a choice, and so is refusing them. Design can build trust or break it. I want to build it.
-  **Be honest about how I make things.** I use AI tools for efficiency and coding, not to replace the fundamentals of creative work. I want to be upfront about it, not pretend every pixel came from scratch. Disclosure isn't weakness. It's integrity.
-  **Representation isn't decoration.** I live on the unceded territories of the Musqueam, Squamish, and Tsleil-Waututh peoples, and I come from Hokkaido, the ancestral homeland of the Ainu people. Both communities remind me that representation carries real weight. When I create work that features people, I always want to ask: would they feel respected, or used?
-  **Protect the craft, mine and everyone else's.** My mom was a fashion designer. I grew up watching her work, and she made so many pieces that literally coloured my life. So when I see design theft, or AI trained on stolen work, it hits differently. I want to credit people, pay fair rates, and never undercut the designers around me.
-  **Know when to say no.** Spec work, harmful briefs, clients who don't respect the process. Saying no is a skill and a professional one. I don't contribute to free work either. Knowing my own value is also a way of supporting every other creator who deserves to be paid fairly.
-  **Keep asking questions.** My thinking about design ethics started somewhere really basic, like "don't plagiarize" or "just be a decent human being." I never got to put it into my own words. Now I do. The habit of asking who benefits, who gets left out, and what the real cost is, that is actually the whole point.

Tension 葛藤

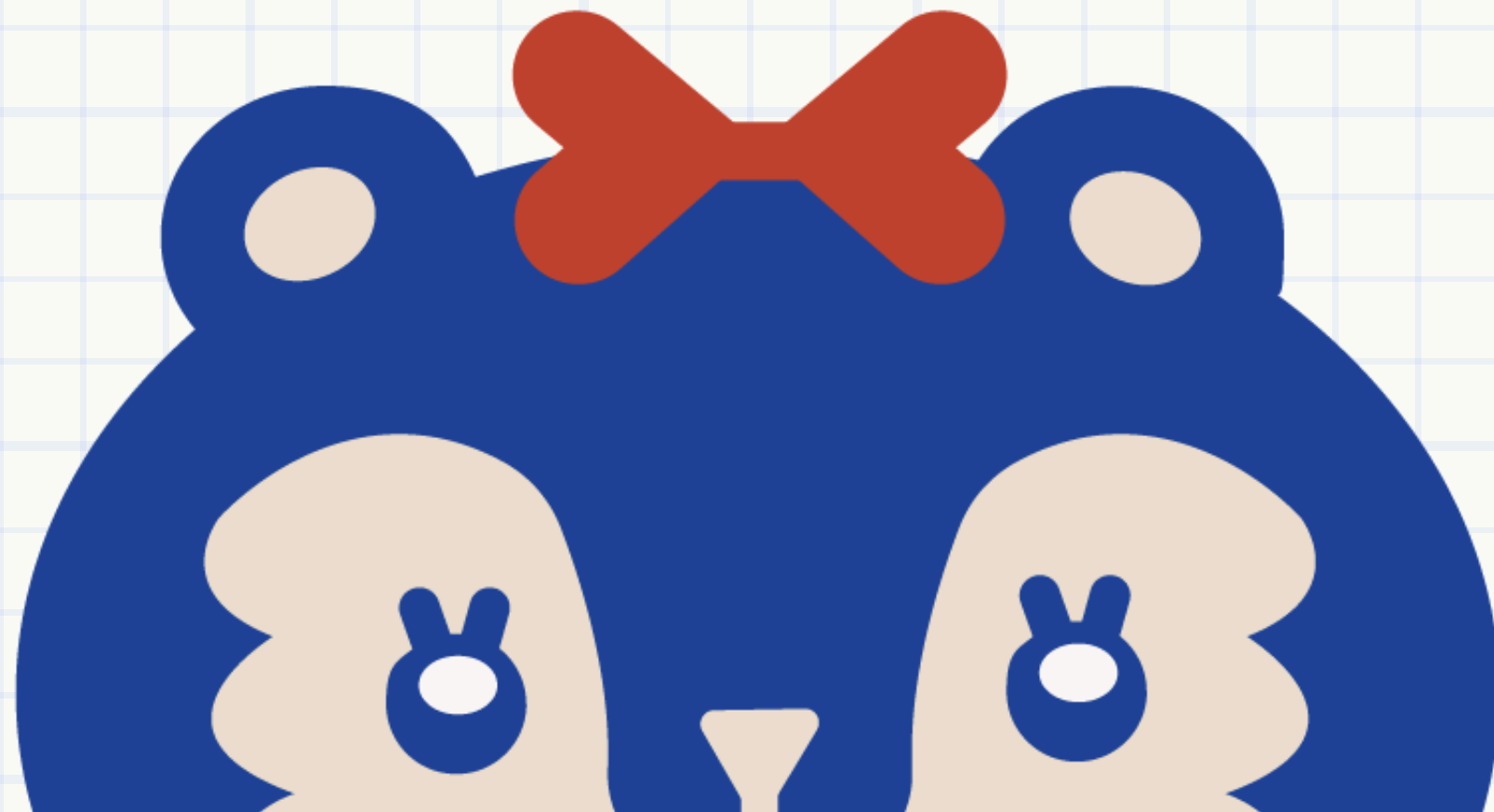
Tension 01: AI efficiency vs. creative authenticity

I use **AI** to brainstorm ideas, write code, and speed up my workflow. But there is a real question underneath all of that: at what point does relying on AI start to hollow out my own skills? And what do I owe to the artists whose work trained these models? I don't have a clean answer yet. But I think the minimum I can do is **be transparent about when and how I use AI, and keep pushing myself to develop my own eye.**



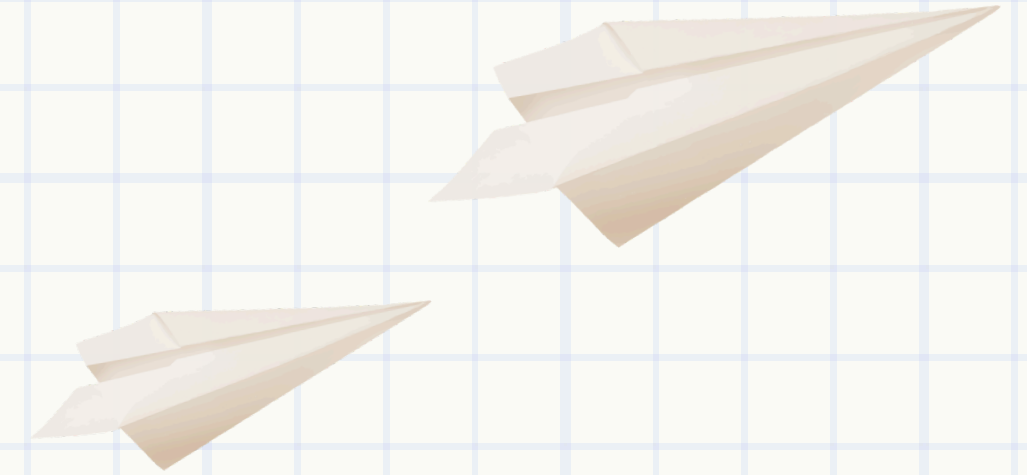
Tension 02: Client wants vs. audience harm

In brand and marketing design, you will eventually receive a brief that asks you to exaggerate. The client pays you. The audience doesn't. This is the tension I worry about most, because it is subtle. Nobody hands you a brief that says "please deceive people." It usually just looks like "make it more exciting" or "soften the negative." I want to be the designer who names that tension out loud, even when it's a bit uncomfortable.



How My Thinking Has Evolved

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Before taking CREA 7100 at BCIT, I thought ethics in design was a fairly small idea, such as not plagiarizing or just being a decent human being. I had not yet captured the full picture. Now I see a much bigger and more personal scope. It is about who I want to be when a client pressures me, or when I am on a tight deadline and tempted to cut corners. The frameworks we studied helped me most. Virtue ethics in particular, which is the idea that good decisions come from building good character over time rather than just following a list of rules, changed how I think about my own practice. It is not about what you are allowed to do. It is about who you are becoming. I am still figuring out where I stand on AI and authorship. But I think being confused and honest is better than being somehow certain and wrong.

